



Guildford County School
SPECIALIST MUSIC COLLEGE

YEAR 9
GCSE OPTIONS PROCESS
2025/2026
SUBJECT BOOKLET

Dear Students and Families,

This booklet has comprehensive information designed to help guide you towards your decision about what GCSEs you wish to take next year. The Options Process in Year 9 is an exciting time of thinking ahead and making decisions for your future. Knowing what you want to do when you're older is one of the toughest questions to answer, but no matter where you are in terms of answering this big question, choosing your options presents an opportunity for you to think carefully about the next step in your education. As a reminder, please do not be swayed by the decisions of your peers. Focus on **you** and **your** future and don't make choices based on who you might be in a class with. This is an independent process, and your GCSE results will have an impact on you alone.

Please continue to reach out to the support network available to you at school and at home over the next couple of months, asking as many questions as you need – this applies to students and families alike.

I am so pleased to be your Head of Year and already proud of the wonderful things you will achieve. Best of luck making your decision.

Ms. Breckenridge

Five Top Tips

1. Enjoyment

- Think about what subjects you already enjoy or new ones that you might enjoy.
- Have a look through the subject outlines that follow these tips.
- Note down some questions you want to ask Heads of Department on Options Evening or your subject teacher.

2. Excelling

- Look at your IR1 data in November- where are you excelling?
- Ask your subject teachers if you are a good candidate for GCSE.

3. Workload

- Make sure you spend some time understanding the type of work that will be required. For example, how much time will you be expected to work outside of lessons? And on what type of work?
- Be realistic about what is possible and fits with other commitments you might have.
- Review the examination process: Is there coursework? Is it all exams at the end of Year 11?

4. Curiosity:

- Be curious about options and where they could lead you in the future
- Don't choose subjects based on your friends' choices.

5. Kindness

- Be kind to your parents, carers and friends, even when you are feeling stressed.
- This includes allowing others to have an involvement in your process and giving them the opportunity to take an interest. **But remember, ultimately the decision is yours to make.**

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Are there any subjects that I must take?

Yes, all students take compulsory courses in Mathematics, Science (two qualifications), English Language, English Literature. All students must also take either a Humanity (Geography or History) OR a Modern Foreign Language. Alongside these GCSE subjects, students also continue with non-examined, but compulsory studies of Physical Education, Personal and Community Education.

How many “Options” do I choose?

In total, **four** but one of these is **compulsory** (Language OR History OR Geography). You have **three** free choices, one of which may be Triple Science.

Can I study both Humanities?

Yes. You can study both History and Geography.

Can I study two Languages?

Yes. You can study two languages.

Am I guaranteed to get my top choices?

In most cases, students receive their preferred options. In some instances, we are unable to meet the first choices and so students are also asked to choose **two reserve options**.

Can anyone choose Triple Science?

In Science, the Triple Award is an option by invitation. As explained by Dr Whiteman in previous correspondence, students are required to make the choice by **Monday 3 November 2025** about whether they wish to choose Triple Science. This choice will then be confirmed after students show the needed expertise in their November science exams and during lessons and assessments this term.

Am I guaranteed to get my choices?

We can't guarantee it. However, most students get most of their first choices. Every year, though, some (usually fewer than 10) students will need to select a reserve option. We will talk to you if this applies to you and make sure you are happy with your option choices.

Where can I get help in making my decisions?

You have lots of resources to use, including this booklet and speaking to your teachers. Make sure you come to the Options Evening on **Thursday 15 January 2026** as well. You will be able to hear what teachers say about their subjects and the work ethic you will need in each of them. Make a list of questions you have as you go along, and don't worry if it takes you a while to come to your decision.

Should I listen to my friends?

Maybe. But remember that your friends are them, not you – they will like different things to you and be better at different things than you are. Definitely do not pick an option because your friend is, but it is good to be there to support one another through the process.

Are some subjects better than others?

No. Some subjects might be better for you, depending on what you enjoy and what you find success in. Teachers won't be competitive and tell you their subject is better than others. We want you to make the best decision for you based on what you enjoy and excel in.

Can't you just tell me what to pick?

Sorry, no! We're here to provide you with information and guide you in your decision-making process, but ultimately, the decision is yours. Part of growing up is learning to make decisions like this; experiencing the excitement and challenge is all part of it.

How do I hand in my choices?

We will be using an online form this year. After Options Evening, you will be sent a link to this form.

What's the deadline for the Options Form?

You must complete the online form by Thursday 22 January. A lot of work goes on behind the scenes for us to have your timetables ready for September, so you will not be able to submit after this date.

If I leave the “reserve choices” blank, does this mean I stand more chance of getting my preferred options?

No. You must select reserve options. If not, your form will bounce back, and your options will be delayed.

Who should I ask if I have any other questions?

Your tutor is a good starting point, but any teacher would be delighted to help you if we can. You can also ask myself or Mr Bramwells – we are here to support you!

COMPULSORY CORE EXAMINATION COURSES

Subject Title: English Language

Examination Board: AQA Tier Structure and Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

English GCSE is a vital part of your GCSE studies – that's why it's not optional! You will need a pass in English to gain entry either to college or employment in the future.

What will I be taught?

You will be taught how to analyse a variety of texts, including non-fiction and fiction. The course also includes a writing element, covering a range of styles and audiences. You will also get an opportunity to air your feelings, as we believe in the importance of speaking and listening.

How will I learn?

You will learn using as many styles as possible. We use a range of stimulus materials from leaflets to television adverts, extracts to movies. You will work on your own, in groups, as a whole class, depending on the task.

What skills will I learn?

You will learn the skills needed to communicate effectively in the world outside school.

Subject Title: English Literature

Examination Board: AQA Tier Structure and Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

Along with English Language, all students complete the literature GCSE course. In this section of the course, we concentrate on responding to a variety of forms of literature, including novels, plays and poems.

What will I be taught?

You will be taught close analysis of texts including drama, poetry, prose and of course, Shakespeare.

How will I learn?

You will be encouraged to formulate your own opinions on texts, based upon what other readers think and the relevant contextual information surrounding the text. You will use these opinions to write analytical essays on what you have studied.

What skills will I learn?

You will learn the skills of constructing, justifying and developing an argument both orally and written.

Subject Title: Mathematics

Examination Board: Edexcel Tier Structure and Grades 9-1

General Statement:

GCSE Maths builds on what you have learnt in lower school. You will revisit topics and develop your understanding further and have some topics that will be new to you. Studying maths gives you a wide variety of problems-solving skills that will help in a vast array of jobs, studying Maths equips you for future careers and therefore is compulsory for everyone. Through the Maths course you have the chance to:

- Develop your knowledge, skills and understanding of mathematical methods and concepts.
- Learn how to choose the right mathematical techniques to solve problems.
- Reason mathematically, make deductions and draw conclusions.

Communicate mathematical information in a variety of forms appropriate to the information and context

What will I be taught?

Number including: decimal (base 10) number system; properties of integers; arithmetic with the operations of addition, multiplication, radicals (e.g. squaring, cubing etc) and their inverses with integers, fractions and decimals.

Algebra (generalising arithmetic) including: notation; linear and quadratic functions; set up and solve linear and quadratic equations.

Ratio, proportion and change including: direct and inverse proportion; compound units such as speed, density, pressure and rates of change.

Geometry and measures: including: geometry (e.g. Circle Theorems, properties of parallel lines, shapes); mensuration; trigonometry; vectors.

Probability including: tools for evaluating the outcome of independent and conditional events (Venn diagrams, tree diagrams, two-way tables).

Statistics including: use and limitations of sampling, displaying data that doesn't mislead a reader, interpret and analyse data in various forms; how to be aware of misleading representations of data.

How will I learn?

You will learn these skills using a variety of learning styles, including pair work, whole class discussion, individual practice and through investigations. You will receive regular homework to practice and ingrain the skills and knowledge you learn in class.

How and when will I be assessed?

Depending on which strand you follow you will either be following the Foundation or Higher Tier, both of which are linear with final exams after two years. The linear course is examined fully in Year 11 with three final examinations, each of 1 and a half hours each. There is no coursework.

Subject Title: Combined Science

Examination Board: AQA Trilogy Tier Structure and Grades: Higher 9-4, Foundation 5-1

General Statement:

Science is a subject specialising in the concept of describing and explaining the world around us. It is in human nature to wonder 'Why?'. From a young age, normally around the time you first learn to speak, humans will ask the question why. This could be why is the sky blue? Why are we similar to apes? Why are there animals and plants that are different? Why are we alive? Why is the Earth round? Why, why, why!

Thankfully, Science as a subject in the broadest sense is a required subject for students at GCSE. Combined Science is the minimum level that is required by government, and involves a broad and balanced curriculum containing most areas of Chemistry, Physics and Biology.

The subject builds on the skills and knowledge that you gained over the last 3 years in secondary school as well as the fundamental principles learnt in primary school. Science requires you apply your knowledge and skills from not just science lessons, but also Maths and English – provide you with the ability to explain more of the world around you.

Science is a vital subject at GCSE that opens up a variety of careers, not just the traditional sciences, but also via the problem-solving nature of the course. Careers can include Finance, Veterinary, Medical, Dentistry, Engineering, Architecture, Natural Sciences, Space, Construction, Design, Computing and Accountancy.

What will I be taught?

The Biology component includes:

- Cells and Organisation;
- Disease and Bioenergetics;
- Biological Responses;
- Genetics and Reproduction;
- Ecology.

The Chemistry component includes:

- Atoms, Bonding and Moles;
- Chemical and Energy Changes;
- Rates, Equilibrium and Organic Chemistry;
- Analysis and the Earth's Resources.

The Physics component includes:

- Energy and Energy Resources;
- Electricity
- Particles at Work;
- Forces in Action;
- Waves and Electromagnetism

How will I learn?

Students will learn using a variety of learning styles, including pair work, whole class discussion, practical investigations and individual presentation. There will also be 21 required practical which will be examined in the final examinations at the end of Year 11. You will receive regular home learning in addition to class work and revision tasks.

What skills will I learn?

You will learn:

The application of scientific knowledge and how science works

- Investigative skills
- Practical skills
- Analytical skills
- Evaluation of evidence
- Research
- Presentations
- ICT skills
- Implications of Science for society

How and when will I be assessed?

Exams will be taken at the end of Year 11. The tier of entry (Higher or Foundation) will be decided based on student progress and teacher assessment. All three sciences must be sat at the same tier. There are no exams in Year 10 and there is no coursework component. There will be 6 exams, each lasting 1 hour 15 minutes. You will be awarded a double grade (the equivalent to 2 GCSE's).

OPTIONAL EXAMINATION COURSES

Subject Title: Art, Craft & Design

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades 9-1

General Statement:

Art, Craft and Design aims to stimulate interest and enjoyment in creative work. The course is broad in approach, exploring practical and critical/contextual work through a range of 2D and/or 3D processes and new media and technologies. Motivation, personal initiative and commitment are essential for success. It is not recommended that students take both Art, Craft & Design and Photography.

What will I be taught?

You will extend your experiences of processes and skills through a short practical foundation course, learning new skills and techniques and working in a variety of media.

You will work on at least 2 themes and explore relevant images, artefacts and resources relating to Art, Craft and Design from the past and from recent times, to inspire your investigation and making processes. Your research will be shown through practical and critical activities which demonstrate your understanding of different styles, genres and traditions in the subject. As part of the Art, Craft & Design course,

you must explore and create work associated with areas of study from at least two titles listed below.

- Fine art (e.g., drawing, painting, print sculpture)
- Graphic communication: (e.g., illustration, package design)
- Textile design: (e.g., fashion/costume design and illustration, printed/dyed textiles)
- Three-dimensional design: (architectural design, ceramics, body adornment.
- Photography

You will present your work in sketchbooks/workbooks/journals and in a portfolio.

How will I learn?

You will learn through practical work in the following ways: -

- By experimenting and experience with various media and techniques
- By working in two and three dimensions with a variety of media
- By making art, making mistakes and experimenting
- By analysing and interpreting artists and designers approaches and techniques
- Visits to galleries and museums
- Using ICT to research information and to develop practical work
- Through discussion and enquiry

What skills will I learn?

You will learn to develop your personal imaginative responses and perceptual and visual skills. Design and composition/Presentation and organisational skills/ Problem solving/Developing ideas/How to analyse and annotate artwork/Evaluation/Display/Communication and group work. You will also learn to develop a unit of artwork from the initial idea to a final outcome.

How and when will I be assessed?

You will complete two components and be assessed on the quality of work in 4 key areas: Development, Experimentation, Recording and Presenting.

Component 1: Portfolio is 60% of the GCSE

The portfolio must include a sustained project evidencing the journey from initial engagement to the realisation of intentions and a selection of work undertaken during the 2-year course. This must show explicit coverage of the four assessment objectives.

Component 2: Externally set assignment: 40% of GCSE

You will respond to your chosen starting point from an externally set assignment paper. The work produced must show explicit coverage of the four assessment objectives, the 'final piece/s' or conclusion of this project will be completed during a 10-hour period of supervised time in March / April of the final term. Preparation studies for this unit are started in January, a few months before the practical examination.

All artwork is marked internally and externally moderated. Assessment is ongoing using the GCSE art and design assessment criteria.

Subject Title: Art & Design; Textiles

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

Art and Design Textiles aims to stimulate interest and enjoyment in creative work. Textile design is defined as the creation of designs and products for woven, knitted, stitched, printed or decorative textiles that might have a functional or non-functional purpose. Students will develop and apply the knowledge, understanding and skills specified in the subject content to realise personal intentions relevant to textile design and their selected area(s) of study.

Motivation, personal initiative, persistence and commitment are essential for success.

What will I be taught?

You will extend your experiences of processes and skills through a short practical foundation course, learning new skills and techniques and working in a variety of textile related media.

You will work on at least 2 themes and explore relevant images, artefacts and resources relating to historical and contemporary Textile Art, to inspire your investigation and making processes. Your research will be shown through practical and critical activities which demonstrate your understanding of different styles, genres and traditions in the subject.

You must explore and create work associated with areas of study from at least two listed below.

- fashion/costume design and illustration
- printed/dyed textiles
- woven and constructed textiles
- embellishment and jewellery
- digital or installation textiles.

You will present your work in sketchbooks/ workbooks/ journals and in a portfolio.

How will I learn?

You will learn through practical work in the following ways: -

- By experimenting and experience with various media and techniques
- By working in two and three dimensions with a variety of media
- By making textiles
- By analysing and interpreting artists and designers' approaches and techniques
- Visits to galleries and museums
- Using ICT to research information and to develop practical work •
- Through discussion and enquiry

What skills will I learn?

You will learn to develop your personal imaginative responses and perceptual and visual skills.

Design and composition/Presentation and organisational skills/ Problem solving/Developing ideas/How to analyse and annotate artwork/Evaluation/Display/Communication and group work.

You will also learn to develop a unit of artwork from the initial idea to a final outcome.

How and when will I be assessed?

You will complete two components and be assessed on the quality of work in 4 key areas: Development, Experimentation, Recording and Presenting.

Component 1: Portfolio is 60% of the GCSE

The portfolio must include a sustained project evidencing the journey from initial engagement to the realisation of intentions and a selection of work undertaken during the 2-year course. This must show explicit coverage of the four assessment objectives.

Component 2: Externally set assignment 40% of the GCSE

You will respond to your chosen starting point from an externally set assignment paper. The work produced must show explicit coverage of the four assessment objectives, the 'final piece/s' or conclusion of this project will be completed during a 10-hour period of supervised time in March/April of the final term. Preparation studies for this unit start in January, a few months before the practical examination.

All artwork is marked internally and externally moderated. Assessment is ongoing using the GCSE art and design assessment criteria.

Subject Title: GCSE Business

Examination Board: OCR, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

Whatever you end up doing in life you will be in business. You might run your own, manage someone else's, work for one or simply buy from many. This course will help you develop real business skills you can use throughout your life.

What will I be taught?

Unit 1: Business activity, marketing and people

This unit introduces students to the purpose, objectives, structure and stakeholders who influence businesses as they start and as they grow, focussing on the concept of enterprise. The unit also looks at marketing (how businesses identify customer needs and provide the right products in the right place at the right price to satisfy them) and human resources (how businesses recruit the right people and get the best out of them)

Unit 2: Operations, Finance and influences on business

This unit looks at how businesses actually produce their goods and services (identifying efficient processes, managing quality and providing customer service). Finance (raising finance, calculating and forecasting profit and cash flow) as well as the external factors affecting business performance (such as ethics, the economy and globalisation)

How will I learn?

You will learn in a variety of ways. There is a strong focus on learning by doing: taking part in role play activities in quality assurance, customer service and recruitment, playing business games to develop operations and accounting skills as well as mock planning application debates to develop logical chains of argument. You will look at a number of case studies from real businesses (through reading news articles, watching video, and listening to visiting speakers), analysing what makes them successful. You will also learn to solve problems creatively, using a range of skills and techniques.

What skills will I learn?

You will learn problem-solving skills, including reading comprehension, analytical mathematics techniques, using these to logically identify specific issues, propose solutions and evaluate the best solution for the business in its present situation. You will develop a precise, concise business-like writing style. Through learning by doing, you will develop team skills (leadership, reliability, negotiation and co-operation) as well as personal presentation skills.

How and when will I be assessed?

Two 90-minute exams at the end of Year 11:

Unit 1: Business activity, marketing and people (50%)

Unit 2: Operations, Finance and influences on business (50%)

Subject Title: Computer Science

Examination Board: OCR, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

Computing is of enormous importance to the economy, and the role of Computer Science as a discipline itself is growing rapidly as an 'underpinning' subject across Science, Technology, Maths, and Engineering. This is typically important in technology-related industries and for those seeking to study Maths and Science in Higher Education, which all require knowledge of programming. However, most business today require an ever-increasing number of technologically aware individuals, including many humanitarian-based fields, such as medicine, law, charities, and healthcare. This course has been designed with this in mind.

What will I be taught?

Students will learn how to create their own applications, create simple computer programs, gain an understanding of the fundamental concepts around creating software applications and have opportunities to work collaboratively to gain experience as working as part of a development team. Students will additionally learn networking, database programming such as SQL, algorithm design and the fundamentals of high-level programming. Students will learn how computers work, and the role of each component required to make it work.

How will I learn?

Learning will be in the form of theory, practical-based problem-solving activities, class discussions and frequent demonstrations with examples before students get to attempt the task themselves. Independence and resilience are encouraged, and progress tracked to help prepare students for higher education, equipping them with the required skills to be successful in their future careers. An interactive Improvement Log with electronic feedback has been created to support students in their learning by tracking their understanding of each topic, ensuring students are aware of how they can improve throughout their journey. Students will have access to a dedicated Microsoft Teams area for their class, with individualised Class Notebooks that can be accessed from anywhere with any device.

What skills will I learn?

Problem Solving, Programming, Algorithm Design, Team Working, How a Computer Works, Hardware Components and Computer Networks.

How and when will I be assessed?

50% Computer Systems:

1 ½ Hour Exam assessed externally.

50% Computational Thinking, Algorithms and Programming: 1 ½ Hour Exam assessed externally.

Subject Title: Drama

Examination Board: OCR, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

Drama is a fun, academic challenging option at GCSE. It is a chance for you to explore your imagination and take on the role of a performer or designer, producing varied pieces of drama, set and stage design, costume and make-up.

What will I be taught?

You will be taught how to perform a variety of different forms of drama, from scripted work to creating your own pieces of theatre. You will also be taught how to analyse live theatre seen. The option to develop your technical and design skills is also a feature of GCSE Drama; learning through the use of costume, set, lighting and sound.

How will I learn?

You will learn mainly through practical workshops, discussions and evaluations. There will also be many opportunities of seeing live theatre productions.

You must be fully committed to the course, as your spare time will be called upon for rehearsals. You will also learn by working as a team member: you must be able to work with anyone!

What skills will I learn?

The course shows that you can cope with the demands of a practical subject, as well as having the skill and commitment needed to work in a team. You will gain a developed analytical skill and a greater understanding of the world of live theatre.

Key Skills for work:

Being able to work with a range of people

Communication and cooperation

Creativity

Independent planning and working

Adaptability and flexibility

How and when will I be assessed?

40% Written Exam

Set Play and Live Theatre Production

1 Hour 30 mins

60% non-exam material

Devising Drama

Texts in Practice

Subject Title: Design & Technology

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement

Design and Technology is a practical and theoretical subject which requires the application of knowledge and understanding when planning and developing ideas that are then made and evaluated.

What will I be taught?

Students will study a core base of technical principles and develop an in-depth understanding of: -

- New and emerging technologies.
- Energy, Materials, Systems and devices.
- Materials and their working properties
- Common & Specialist technical principles including; Timbers, Metals, Paper & Boards, Electronic systems
- Designing Principles
- Making Principles

Students will be able to combine skills and techniques from Resistant Materials and Graphics to form their response to a chosen contextual challenge. This non-exam assessment (NEA) is 50% of the final grade. The NEA is the large project section where students research, design, develop and make a product, in response to one of three contextual challenges set by AQA each academic year prior to its submission.

How will I learn?

Through designing and making products with creativity and originality, using a range of materials and techniques. Students will be enthused and challenged by the range of practical activities possible. You shall also visit the Design Museum, and create personal resources that enable you to retain and recall information.

What skills will I learn?

Students will be taught to: -

- Select and use tools and appropriate equipment to produce quality products.
- Problem solve technical problems as an integral part of the design process.
- Use tools and equipment safely with regard to themselves and others.
- Work accurately and efficiently in terms of time, materials and components.
- Manufacture products applying quality control checks and procedures.
- Use CAD/CAM.
- Use science and maths to work out the quantity of materials needed and used.
- Develop their work using the iterative process that is fully justified.

How and when will I be assessed?

NEA (coursework design and make project) 50%

Written exam 50%

Subject Title: Food Preparation and Nutrition

Examination Board: EDUQAS, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

The Food Preparation and Nutritional GCSE would appeal to anyone who has a passion for Food. It will enable students to develop their skills and create nutritional and creative dishes. Understanding the function of ingredients in recipes and delving deep into the food science and nutrition forms a key part of the course. Practical work complements the theory and skill levels are developed to allow students to produce high skill dishes to an exceptional standard.

You will learn about food commodities, nutrition, diet and good health, the science of cooking food, food spoilage, health and safety, food provenance, food waste, cultures and cuisines, technological developments and factors affecting food choice.

What will I be taught?

Practical's:

General practical skills, knife skills, use of the cooker, use of equipment, cooking methods, prepare, combine and shape, sauce making, tenderise and marinate, bread, pastry, pasta, meat and fish, dairy foods and fruit and vegetables.

Theory:

Food, Nutrition and Healthy eating. Food science. Food safety. Food choice and Food provenance.

How will I learn?

You will learn through practical sessions, experimenting/ investigating and making comparisons between products. Through discussion and enquiry, you will develop a deeper understanding of food preparation techniques and the importance of nutrition. You shall also create personal resources that enable you to retain and recall information for assessments. The practical cooking lessons make up about 40% of the GCSE and the rest is theory-based lessons.

What skills will I learn?

You will be taught a wide variety of skills including higher level food preparation and cooking methods. You will learn various ways of presenting food ready to serve. Develop better health and food production. Consider the influence of lifestyle and consumer choice when developing meals and recipes. This all prepares you for your theory and practical exam at the end of your course.

How and when will I be assessed?

Written exam: 1 hour 45 minutes. 100 marks. 50% of GCSE

Task 1: Food science investigation (30 marks) 15%

Task 2: Food preparation assessment (70 marks) 35%

Subject Title: Geography

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement

Geography is everywhere and through doing this course you will develop the sense of “awe and wonder” that will allow you to fully appreciate and learn from the world around you. You will gain an understanding of the physical and human processes that shape our world, and how these produce changes over time. You will learn to appreciate the interaction and the interdependence of the physical and human environments, and the need for sustainable management of both. The course will give you an understanding of alternative futures and an awareness of the possibilities for involvement in planning and creating for the future.

What will I be taught?

Paper 1: Living with the Physical Environment

The topics in this unit include:

The Challenge of Natural Hazards; Physical Landscapes in the UK; The Living World

Paper 2: Challenges in the Human Environment

The topics in this unit include:

Urban Issues and Challenges; The Changing Economic World; The Challenge Resource Management

Paper 3: Geographical Applications

This paper will include:

An Issue Evaluation (with pre-release material); Fieldwork; Geographical Skills

How will I learn?

You will learn about the world in which you live in a variety of ways. You will learn on your own, and you will learn in small groups. You will learn using books and maps, ICT (including GIS – Geographical Information Systems) and fieldwork. You will learn through whole class discussion, and you will learn by thinking, empathising, and asking questions. You will learn through looking, listening and doing!

What skills will I learn?

Throughout the GCSE course you will develop a wide range of skills, many of which will prove useful beyond Geography. These include communication skills; graphical and cartographical skills; technological skills (including ICT and GIS); interpersonal skills through debate and discussion; literacy and numeracy; problem solving skills; and entrepreneurial skills and awareness of career possibilities.

In addition, you will be encouraged to learn independently, and to develop your ability to ask questions through enquiry-based learning.

How and when will I be assessed?

Paper 1: Living with the Physical Environment

This makes up 35% of the total GCSE, and it is assessed in a 1 hour 30-minute examination

Paper 2: Challenges in the Human Environment

This makes up 35% of the total GCSE, and it is assessed in a 1 hour 30-minute examination

Paper 3: Geographical Applications

This makes up 30% of the GCSE, and it is assessed in a 1 hour 30-minute examination. It will include the use of pre-release resources.

Subject Title: History

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

This new GCSE course offers a broad range of historical topics and will appeal to all students who have enjoyed History at Lower School. It combines medieval and modern units, focussing on the development of Britain from 1066, as well as how medicine has evolved in this time. The course also includes European and world history and a study on the development of the USA in the 20th Century.

What will I be taught?

You will study the following units:

- America 1920-1973: Opportunity and Equality. This unit investigates the boom-and-bust years of the 1920s and 30s, and the development of the Civil Rights movement in the USA.
- Conflict and tension 1918-1939. Students will focus on the inter-war years, studying the impact of the Treaty of Versailles on international relations and the steps to the Second World War.
- Britain: Health and the people c1000 to the present. This unit will focus on the development of medicine across time, including a focus on surgery.
- Norman England c1066-c1100. Students will learn how Britain was shaped following the Battle of Hastings, and how these impacts modern methods of ruling.

What skills will I learn?

You will be taught how to communicate through discussion and presentations, and regularly use sources to test their usefulness. You will be able to interpret and evaluate information and learn how to analyse situations and events. Explaining your ideas and using historical evidence to support these is an important element of the course.

How and when will I be assessed?

Two written examinations at the end of Year 11

Paper 1: Understanding the Modern World

USA and Inter War units (2 hours, 50% of GCSE)

Paper 2: Shaping the Nation

Medicine and 1066 units (2 hours, 50% of GCSE)

Languages:**Subject Title: Latin**

Examination Board: OCR, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

The course is available to all those who have studied Latin during Year 9.

What will I be taught?

You will learn to develop and deploy your knowledge of vocabulary, morphology and syntax in order to read, understand and interpret Latin. You will also learn to develop your knowledge and understanding of ancient literature, values and society through the study of original texts.

How will I learn?

During Year 10 we will continue to use the Cambridge Latin Course for language work and study of the cultural topics. We will look at some of the shorter verse texts from the OCR Latin Anthology in Year 10 and complete the study of set texts in Year 11.

What skills will I learn?

You will learn linguistic and problem-solving skills. You will also learn skills of literary and cultural evaluation.

How and when will I be assessed?

OCR's GCSE (9-1) in Latin consists of three components that are externally assessed at the end of the course. You must sit the language component. You will also sit a prose literature component and a verse literature component.

Component weightings are as follows:

Language 50%

Prose Literature 25%

Verse Literature 25%

Subject Title: French

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

The course is available to all those who have studied French during Year 9. This course encourages students to develop confidence in, and a positive attitude towards, French and to recognise the importance of languages. It also provides a strong linguistic and cultural foundation for students who go on to study French at a higher-level post-16. Through studying GCSE French, students should develop their ability and ambition to communicate independently in speech and writing with speakers of the language for authentic purposes and about subjects which are meaningful and interesting to them. The study of French at GCSE should also build students' confidence and broaden their horizons, enabling them to step beyond familiar cultural boundaries, develop new ways of seeing the world, and better understand relationships between the foreign language and the English language. It is important that students following a GCSE French course should become familiar with aspects of the contexts and cultures of the countries and communities where the language is spoken.

What will I be taught?

You will learn how to:

- apply the principles by which spelling represents sounds in standard or widely used forms of the language, and use clear and comprehensible pronunciation when speaking the language
- use the language both receptively and productively, in spoken and written forms, for a range of audiences and purposes, in different genres and in formal and informal contexts which are relevant to their current and future needs and interests, having regard to the likely experiences of a wide social range
- be able to recall and use language in different situations and be able to move between French and English.

How will I learn?

Throughout Years 10 and 11, we will follow the AQA course textbook, studying the language within a range of different contexts which include:

Theme 1: People and lifestyle

- Topic 1: Identity and relationships with others
- Topic 2: Healthy living and lifestyle
- Topic 3: Education and work

Theme 2: Popular culture

- Topic 1: Free-time activities
- Topic 2: Customs, festivals and celebrations
- Topic 3: Celebrity culture

Theme 3: Communication and the world around us

- Topic 1: Travel and tourism, including places of interest
- Topic 2: Media and technology
- Topic 3: The environment and where people live

What skills will I learn?

You will learn how to:

- understand written texts in French. Texts will predominantly focus on the defined vocabulary and grammar for each tier and will be of limited complexity at Foundation tier

- understand spoken extracts comprising the defined vocabulary and grammar for each tier which are delivered at a pace which is no faster than a moderate pace, where each word is clearly discernible (as appropriate to pronunciation norms for each language), and which do not contain extraneous distractions or interruptions
- undertake dictation of short, spoken extracts (including some vocabulary from outside the vocabulary list) with credit for accurate spelling
- write text in French in a lexically and grammatically accurate way in response to simple and familiar stimuli
- translate in writing short sentences or texts, from French to English and vice versa, using a range of the vocabulary and grammar specified for each tier. In this context, translation means an appropriate and sufficient rendering of the meaning of the original language
- infer, by using knowledge of the vocabulary and grammar specified for each tier, plausible meanings of single words from outside the vocabulary list when they are embedded in the context of written sentences
- speak using clear and comprehensible language to:
 - read aloud a short, written text in French and undertake a short unprepared conversation relating to the text
 - undertake a Role-play, including asking and answering questions, simulating a context such as a social conversation, where instructions about what to say are unambiguous;
 - talk about visual stimuli and extend this conversation into a short unprepared interaction.

How and when will I be assessed?

AQA's GCSE (9-1) in French consists of three components that are externally assessed, and one internally assessed (Speaking) at the end of the course.

Component weightings are as follows:

Listening: 25%

Reading: 25%

Speaking: 25%

Writing: 25%

The exams will measure how students have achieved the following assessment objectives.

- AO1: understand and respond to spoken language in speaking and in writing
- AO2: understand and respond to written language in speaking and in writing
- AO3: demonstrate understanding and accurate application of the grammar and vocabulary prescribed in the specification.

Subject Title: German

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

The course is available to all those who have studied German during Year 9. This course encourages students to develop confidence in, and a positive attitude towards, German and to recognise the importance of languages. It also provides a strong linguistic and cultural foundation for students who go on to study German at a higher-level post-16. Through studying GCSE German, students should develop their ability and ambition to communicate independently in speech and writing with speakers of the language for authentic purposes and about subjects which are meaningful and interesting to them. The study of German at GCSE should also build students' confidence and broaden their horizons, enabling them to step beyond familiar cultural boundaries, develop new ways of seeing the world, and better understand relationships between the foreign language and the English language. It is important that students following a GCSE German course should become familiar with aspects of the contexts and cultures of the countries and communities where the language is spoken.

What will I be taught?

You will learn how to:

- apply the principles by which spelling represents sounds in standard or widely used forms of the language, and use clear and comprehensible pronunciation when speaking the language
- use the language both receptively and productively, in spoken and written forms, for a range of audiences and purposes, in different genres and in formal and informal contexts which are relevant to their current and future needs and interests, having regard to the likely experiences of a wide social range
- be able to recall and use language in different situations and be able to move between German and English.

How will I learn?

Throughout Years 10 and 11, we will follow the AQA course textbook, studying the language within a range of different contexts which include:

Theme 1: People and lifestyle

- Topic 1: Identity and relationships with others
- Topic 2: Healthy living and lifestyle
- Topic 3: Education and work

Theme 2: Popular culture

- Topic 1: Free-time activities
- Topic 2: Customs, festivals and celebrations
- Topic 3: Celebrity culture

Theme 3: Communication and the world around us

- Topic 1: Travel and tourism, including places of interest
- Topic 2: Media and technology
- Topic 3: The environment and where people live

What skills will I learn?

You will learn how to:

- understand written texts in German. Texts will predominantly focus on the defined vocabulary and grammar for each tier and will be of limited complexity at Foundation tier

- understand spoken extracts comprising the defined vocabulary and grammar for each tier which are delivered at a pace which is no faster than a moderate pace, where each word is clearly discernible (as appropriate to pronunciation norms for each language), and which do not contain extraneous distractions or interruptions
- undertake dictation of short, spoken extracts (including some vocabulary from outside the vocabulary list) with credit for accurate spelling
- write text in German in a lexically and grammatically accurate way in response to simple and familiar stimuli
- translate in writing short sentences or texts, from German to English and vice versa, using a range of the vocabulary and grammar specified for each tier. In this context, translation means an appropriate and sufficient rendering of the meaning of the original language
- infer, by using knowledge of the vocabulary and grammar specified for each tier, plausible meanings of single words from outside the vocabulary list when they are embedded in the context of written sentences
- speak using clear and comprehensible language to:
 - read aloud a short, written text in German and undertake a short unprepared conversation relating to the text
 - undertake a Role-play, including asking and answering questions, simulating a context such as a social conversation, where instructions about what to say are unambiguous;
 - talk about visual stimuli and extend this conversation into a short unprepared interaction.

How and when will I be assessed?

AQA's GCSE (9-1) in German consists of three components that are externally assessed, and one internally assessed (Speaking) at the end of the course.

Component weightings are as follows:

Listening: 25%

Reading: 25%

Speaking: 25%

Writing: 25%

The exams will measure how students have achieved the following assessment objectives.

- AO1: understand and respond to spoken language in speaking and in writing
- AO2: understand and respond to written language in speaking and in writing
- AO3: demonstrate understanding and accurate application of the grammar and vocabulary prescribed in the specification.

Subject Title: Spanish

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

The course is available to all those who have studied Spanish during Year 9. This course encourages students to develop confidence in, and a positive attitude towards, Spanish and to recognise the importance of languages. It also provides a strong linguistic and cultural foundation for students who go on to study Spanish at a higher-level post-16. Through studying GCSE Spanish, students should develop their ability and ambition to communicate independently in speech and writing with speakers of the language for authentic purposes and about subjects which are meaningful and interesting to them. The study of Spanish at GCSE should also build students' confidence and broaden their horizons, enabling them to step beyond familiar cultural boundaries, develop new ways of seeing the world, and better understand relationships between the foreign language and the English language. It is important that students following a GCSE Spanish course should become familiar with aspects of the contexts and cultures of the countries and communities where the language is spoken.

What will I be taught?

You will learn how to:

- apply the principles by which spelling represents sounds in standard or widely used forms of the language, and use clear and comprehensible pronunciation when speaking the language
- use the language both receptively and productively, in spoken and written forms, for a range of audiences and purposes, in different genres and in formal and informal contexts which are relevant to their current and future needs and interests, having regard to the likely experiences of a wide social range
- be able to recall and use language in different situations and be able to move between Spanish and English.

How will I learn?

Throughout Years 10 and 11, we will follow the AQA course textbook, studying the language within a range of different contexts which include:

Theme 1: People and lifestyle

- Topic 1: Identity and relationships with others
- Topic 2: Healthy living and lifestyle
- Topic 3: Education and work

Theme 2: Popular culture

- Topic 1: Free-time activities
- Topic 2: Customs, festivals and celebrations
- Topic 3: Celebrity culture

Theme 3: Communication and the world around us

- Topic 1: Travel and tourism, including places of interest
- Topic 2: Media and technology
- Topic 3: The environment and where people live

What skills will I learn?

You will learn how to:

- understand written texts in Spanish. Texts will predominantly focus on the defined vocabulary and grammar for each tier and will be of limited complexity at Foundation tier
- understand spoken extracts comprising the defined vocabulary and grammar for each tier which are delivered at a pace which is no faster than a moderate pace, where each word is clearly discernible (as appropriate to pronunciation norms for each language), and which do not contain extraneous distractions or interruptions
- undertake dictation of short, spoken extracts (including some vocabulary from outside the vocabulary list) with credit for accurate spelling
- write text in Spanish in a lexically and grammatically accurate way in response to simple and familiar stimuli
- translate in writing short sentences or texts, from Spanish to English and vice versa, using a range of the vocabulary and grammar specified for each tier. In this context, translation means an appropriate and sufficient rendering of the meaning of the original language
- infer, by using knowledge of the vocabulary and grammar specified for each tier, plausible meanings of single words from outside the vocabulary list when they are embedded in the context of written sentences
- speak using clear and comprehensible language to:
 - read aloud a short, written text in Spanish and undertake a short unprepared conversation relating to the text
 - undertake a Role-play, including asking and answering questions, simulating a context such as a social conversation, where instructions about what to say are unambiguous;
 - talk about visual stimuli and extend this conversation into a short unprepared interaction.

How and when will I be assessed?

AQA's GCSE (9-1) in Spanish consists of three components that are externally assessed, and one internally assessed (Speaking) at the end of the course.

Component weightings are as follows:

Listening: 25%

Reading: 25%

Speaking: 25%

Writing: 25%

The exams will measure how students have achieved the following assessment objectives.

- AO1: understand and respond to spoken language in speaking and in writing
- AO2: understand and respond to written language in speaking and in writing
- AO3: demonstrate understanding and accurate application of the grammar and vocabulary prescribed in the specification.

Subject Title: Media Studies

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General statement:

Media Studies is the study of the ways in which the media affects and shapes all aspects of our lives today. It considers not only how media products are created but also the ways in which audiences are influenced by their consumption.

What will I be taught?

Media Studies engages you in the in-depth study of media products in relation to four areas:

- media language • media representation • media industries • media audiences.

You will study media products from all of the following media forms:

- audio-visual forms (TV, film, radio, advertising and marketing, video games and music video) • online forms (social and participatory media, video games, music video, newspapers, magazines, advertising and marketing) • print forms (newspapers, magazines, advertising and marketing).

How will I learn?

You will learn using as many styles as possible. We use a range of stimulus materials from newspapers to television adverts, social media to video games. You will work on your own, in groups, as a whole class, depending on the task.

What skills will I learn?

You will learn to understand the ways in which the media works and how it impacts upon its audiences. You will also learn how to create media products, focusing on practical, technical and creative skills.

How will I be assessed?

The course is linear and will be examined at the end of Year 11:

Written exam 1 – Industries, audiences and representation: 1 hour 30 minutes - 35% of GCSE.

Written exam 2 - Media language and contexts of the media: 1 hour 30 minutes – 35% of GCSE.

Non-exam assessment – Creating a media product – 30% of GCSE.

Assessed by teachers and moderated by AQA.

Subject Title: Music

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

“Music is life” ... Your talent and potential will be nurtured in the areas of performance, composition and listening. You need to be able to play an instrument or to sing and it is advisable that you have or start individual lessons on an instrument or voice. If you love music, then this is the course for you!

What will I be taught?

The listening paper covers music from Symphonies to Samba; Club Dance to Film Music, The Blues through to Musical Theatre.

These are covered via 3 areas of study:

- The Western Classical Tradition
- Popular Music of the 20th and 21st Centuries
- World Music & Traditional Music

Composition skills range from song writing to quartets and students are asked to link their compositions to an area of study, so this provides a very flexible and individualised opportunity to compose according to your musical strengths and interests. You may present your work on acoustic instruments or via the use of music technology. You are required to write **2** pieces.

Performance – One solo piece and one ensemble. You do not have to have taken a graded exam, but it is expected that in order to access the top grades, you will be playing a piece of grade 4 / 5 standard by Year 11. For your ensemble performance you can play with any member of the school, your teacher or a member of the music department staff if needed.

How will I learn?

We cover a range of learning styles. Aural, visual, analysis, theoretical via written practical and workshops.

Our home Learning is individually set, especially for composition, so that you progress at the rate that is appropriate for you.

We also regularly ask our GCSE students to help with our wider community status work, if they wish, so that our students can transfer and cement their understanding of their own skills. All students are able to continue to participate in concerts and our choirs and ensembles.

What skills will I learn?

You will learn about composition – how to develop original ideas, effective melody writing, accompaniments and arrangement. Performing develops your deliberate practice and nurtures individual talent, expression, confidence and your ability to cope under pressure. Listening makes use of organisation, research, analysis and aural skills.

How and when will I be assessed?

Unit 1 – Understanding Music Written Exam Paper 1 ½ hour, 96 marks 40%

Unit 2 – Performing music NEA 72 marks 30% Minimum length across two pieces is 4 minutes.

Unit 3 – Composing Music x1 piece is NEA and one marked by the board. 72 marks 30% Minimum length across two pieces is 4 minutes

All deadlines are in May of Year 11

Subject Title: Photography

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

Photography: lens-based and light-based media aims to stimulate interest and enjoyment in creative photography. During the course students are required to work in one or more area(s) of photography, for example; portraiture, location, studio, experimental imagery, installation, documentary, photo-journalism, fashion photography. It is possible to explore overlapping areas and combinations. Motivation, personal initiative, persistence and commitment are essential for success

What will I be taught?

You will be introduced to a variety of experiences exploring a range of digital and darkroom techniques and processes in a short foundation course. You will work on at least 3 themes over the 2 years and research relevant images, artefacts and resources relating to photography from the past and from recent times to inspire your investigations and ideas. Your research will be shown through practical and critical activities which demonstrate your understanding of different styles, genres and traditions in photography. Your written annotations will help to explain your ideas, research and project development. Work will be presented in sketchbooks/ workbooks/journals and in a portfolio.

How will I learn?

You will learn through practical work in the following ways: -

- By experimenting and experience with digital and camera less/darkroom skills.
- By developing skills in the use of your camera and taking great photographs.
- By exploring postproduction techniques, both manual and digital such as PowerPoint, Gimp and photoshop.
- By studying and analysing artists and designers approaches and techniques.
- Visits to galleries and museums.
- Using IT to research information and to develop practical work.
- Through discussion and enquiry.

By making 'art' and experimenting/investigating concepts within Photography.

What skills will I learn?

Within the context of photography, you will develop the ability to use photographic techniques and processes, appropriate to your personal intentions, for example: lighting, viewpoint, shutter speed and movement as well as some darkroom techniques and Photoshop skills. You will also learn to develop a project from the initial idea to a final outcome and learn the ways in which meanings, ideas and intentions relevant to photography can be communicated. Broader learning includes: Presentation and organisational skills/ Problem solving/How to develop ideas/How to interpret, analyse and annotate artwork/ Evaluation/visual, written and verbal communication skills.

How and when will I be assessed?

You will complete two components and be assessed on the quality of work in 4 key areas: Development, Experimentation, Recording and Presenting.

Component 1: Portfolio is 60% of the GCSE

The portfolio will include a sustained project evidencing the journey from initial engagement to the realisation of intentions and a selection of work undertaken during the 2-year course. This must show explicit coverage of the four assessment objectives. Themes have included Still life, Light and Dark, Portraiture and Change.

Component 2: Externally set assignment: 40% of the GCSE

Students respond to their chosen starting point from an externally set assignment paper. The work produced must show explicit coverage of the four assessment objectives, the 'final piece/s' or conclusion of this project will be completed during a 10-hour period of supervised time.

In both components, you must identify and acknowledge sources which are not their own and provide evidence of drawing activity and written annotation

- Practical examination - 40% Students produce a final artwork response within a ten-hour period during March/April of the final term. Preparation studies for this unit are started in January, a few months before the practical examination.

All artwork is marked internally and externally moderated.

Assessment is ongoing using the GCSE art and design assessment criteria.

Subject Title: Physical Education

Examination Board: Edexcel, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

Are you passionate about sport and the science behind what makes an elite athlete? Do you like learning new sports? Are you excellent at individual and team sports? If the answer is YES to these questions, then you would enjoy the GCSE Physical Education course. Physical Education is a great choice for those students who excel in a sporting environment and for those who are passionate about the theory behind sport, health and exercise. The GCSE PE course develops knowledge and understanding through practical application. Students are required to demonstrate the factors that underpin performance, apply that within a sporting context and analyse and evaluate these factors within their theory work.

What will I be taught?

The course is split into 2 parts, theory (70%) and practical (30%).

Component 1

- Fitness and body systems – applied anatomy and physiology, movement analysis and physical training

Component 2

- Health and Performance – health fitness and well-being, sport psychology and socio-cultural influences

Component 3

- Practical performance – skills during individual and team activities

Component 4

- Analyse and Evaluate performance – Personal exercise programme (PEP)

How will I learn?

You will learn in a variety of ways. In practical activities, you will learn through demonstrations and performances. You will also apply the theory you have learnt with the overall aim of becoming excellent within 3 sports. Theory lessons will involve written work, alongside building knowledge with as much practical application as possible throughout the course. The PE teachers want you to enjoy the course, so we will always find a way to teach you in a fun, purposeful and rewarding environment. Majority of lesson will be Theory as it is up to you to complete the practical elements through attending clubs either within or outside of school however, we will build in practical lessons to teach some of the theory. These PE lessons are on top of your normal core PE lessons.

What skills will I learn?

You will also learn how to test and develop your own level of fitness. You will learn how to evaluate your own sporting performance and how you can make progress within your chosen sports.

- Ability to analyse data
- Evaluate factors that impact on sport and health
- Correct terminology relating to human anatomy
- Debate skills linked to contemporary issues in Sport
- Apply tactics and decision making in Sport

How and when will I be assessed?

The course will be assessed using the scale 9 – 1 in the following areas:

- Paper 1 - 90 minutes – Applied Anatomy and physiology. Physical Training – End of year 11
- Paper 2 - 75 minutes – Health and wellbeing, Psychology and Socio-cultural influences– End of year 11
- Practical performance – throughout the two-year course putting forward three for assessment
- Personal exercise programme – controlled assessment in Year 11

Subject Title: Philosophy, Religion & Ethics

Examination Board: AQA, Single Tier, Grades: 9-1

General Statement:

“The unexamined life is not worth living and the un-lived life is not worth examining”.

There is no more relevant subject for what is going on in the world! Looking, as we do, at Peace and Conflict, Families and Relationships, Crime and Punishment and Human Rights. We also study how Christians and Muslims live their lives, developing a deep understanding of what drives the behaviour of over half the world's population. What could be more relevant to your own experiences of the world? Be prepared to, as Marx said, “question everything!”

What will I be taught?

We will look at the big issues such as: -

- Is it right to go to war?
- Is there life after death?
- Why does God allow suffering?
- Should abortion be legal?
- Should we execute murderers?
- Beliefs, teachings and practices of Islam and Christianity..... and a lot more!

How will I learn?

You will learn through discussion, debates, asking questions and structured written answers.

What skills will I learn?

- The ability to see different sides to complex issues.
- How to put across your views and argue.
- How to enquire, be critical and take a reflective approach to the study of religion.
- How to ask and reflect on fundamental questions, engage with them intellectually and respond personally.
- Develop their interest in important issues and relate it to the wider world.
- Reflect on and develop their own values, opinions and attitudes in light of their learning.

How and when will I be assessed?

Two exams at the end of Year 11 – 1hr 45 minutes per paper.

Subject Title: Separate Science – Biology, Chemistry and Physics (Triple Award)

General Statement:

Separate Sciences (Triple) is a subject specialising in the concept of describing and explaining the world around us but going into a lot more detail. If you were an inquisitive child and still wonder about the world around us, both on the small scale (micro) and large scale (macro), Triple Science is a subject for you!

It is more demanding than traditional science, and as a result we offer it to the top 70 students per year group, as decided by assessment and the January Assessment.

The subject builds on the skills and knowledge that you have gained over the last 3 years in secondary school as well as the fundamental principles learnt in primary school. Science requires you to apply your knowledge and skills from not just science lessons, but also Maths and English – provide you with the ability to explain more of the world around you.

While Separate sciences are not required to continue at A level in Biology, Chemistry or Physics, the knowledge and additional lesson time given to it really does support your progress and sets you up to succeed at A level!

Science is a vital subject at GCSE that opens up a variety of careers, not just in the traditional sciences, but also via the problem-solving nature of the course. Careers can include Finance, Veterinary, Medical, Dentistry, Engineering, Architecture, Natural Sciences, Space, Construction, Design, Computing and Accountancy.

What will I be taught?

The Biology component includes:

- Cells and Organisation;
- Disease and Bioenergetics;
- Biological Responses;
- Genetics and Reproduction;
- Ecology.

The Chemistry component includes:

- Atoms, Bonding and Moles;
- Chemical and Energy Changes;
- Rates, Equilibrium and Organic Chemistry;
- Analysis and the Earth's Resources.

The Physics component includes:

- Energy and Energy Resources;
- Electricity and Static Electricity
- Particles at Work; • Forces in Action;
- Waves and Electromagnetism.
- Space

How will I learn?

Students will learn using a variety of learning styles, including pair work, whole class discussion, practical investigations and individual presentation. There will also be 21 required practical's which will be examined in the final examinations at the end of Year 11. You will receive regular home learning in addition to class work and revision tasks.

What skills will I learn?

- You will learn:
- The application of scientific knowledge and how science works
- Investigative skills
- Practical skills
- Analytical skills
- Evaluation of evidence
- Research
- Presentations
- ICT skills
- Implications of Science for society

How and when will I be assessed?

Exams will be taken at the end of Year 11. The tier of entry (Higher or Foundation) will be decided based on student progress and teacher assessment. All three sciences must be sat at the same tier. There are no exams in Year 10 and there is no coursework component. There will be 6 exams, each lasting 1 hour 45 minutes. You will be awarded a double grade (the equivalent to 2 GCSE's).

POSSIBLE CAREER PATHS

One of the most common questions asked by students (and sometimes parents) is what careers could taking a particular subject offer to an individual?

Consequently, we have added a couple of pages to help you with your decision making.

Art and Design

Art can be great preparation for any career that requires fine motor-skills, creative thinking, visual literacy, presentation skills, problem solving and an eye for aesthetics.

More specific careers include:

Architect, potter, jeweller, glass artist, costume designer, art critic, interior designer, animator, display/exhibition planner, courtroom artist, botanical artist, art dealer, art therapist, art teacher, fine artist, illustrator, printmaker, art historian, curator, prop maker, theatre set designer, ceramicist, art conservationist, tattoo artist, fashion designer, textile designer, public artist

Art and Design – Textiles

Fashion careers such as buyers or merchandisers, designers of accessories, men's or womenswear or child wear, sportswear designers, fabric technologist or garment technologists.

Industry; machinists or pattern cutters, quality control, specialist machinists.

Retail – visual merchandising, stock control or customer facing.

Journalism – critics, stylists, writers, photographers; PR; illustrators.

Home interiors, automotive interiors, technical fabric developers.

Theatre or Film costume researchers, costume designers or makers, Makeup artists, theatre design, wig makers or wardrobe assistant.

Business Studies

Running your own business, whatever your passion.

Working for a business, exploiting your skills

Computer Science

Computing jobs are among the most lucrative and in surveys consistently have the highest job satisfaction.

Programmer (Games/Applications/Systems)

Scientist

Lawyer

Doctor

Engineer

And many, many, more!

Computer Science is one field where there are more jobs than qualified people to fill them, with a global shortage of women in the industry.

Design Technology

Careers that can be followed with a GCSE in Design Technology (Textiles/Graphics/Resistant Materials and Catering):

Designers
Product design
Automotive design
Textile design
Fabric design within various industries
Technical development/ space/medical /military
Hospitality- Hotel industry/holiday firms
Catering large or small scale
Project managers
Site manager
Carpenter
Set designer-Theatre
Exhibition designers/events managements
Prop makers
Illustrators
Special effects stylists
Visual merchandising
Cabinet making
Building and construction 3
Engineering
Architecture

Drama

GCSE Drama could lead on to further study in Drama, Theatre Studies, Performing Arts and Expressive Arts at A-level and above, or other related subjects such as English, Music, Dance, Art and Design.

Career opportunities – numerous! As well as excellent preparation for careers in the arts, Drama prepares students for any career where public speaking, leading teams, sharing ideas and thinking creatively are necessary. We have had Drama students go on to pursue careers in law, teaching, academia and many more.

English

Journalism
Teaching
Publishing
Medicine
Politics
Law

Food Preparation and Nutrition

Food prep and Nutrition can take you into various careers:

Food Critic, Food Blogger, Michelin star Chef, Food Taster, Restaurant owner, Souz Chef, Pastry Chef, Teacher, Food Technologist, Dietician, Naturopath, Nutritional therapist, Product/process development scientist, Quality manager, Regulatory affairs officer, Scientific laboratory technician, Technical brewer.

Geography

Geography is a broad-based subject which is well respected by employers. Geography graduates have one of the highest rates of graduate employment. Geographers enter a very wide range of career areas and put simply there is no such thing as a geography job, there are jobs that geographers do. Studying geography provides you with valuable skills and a firm base for life-long learning.

Just a few jobs that geographers do:

Discover new places! Travel Agent, Tourism Officer, Eco-Tourism Advisor, Tour Guide, Media Researcher.

Enjoy being in the landscape? Hydrologist, Coastal Manager, Geologist, Civil Engineer, Soil Conservationist

Interested in weather? Weather Presenter, Disaster Manager, Flood Prevention Officer, Risk Assessment, Water Supply Co-ordinator

Care about the Planet? Estate Manager, Forestry Ranger, Environmental Consultant, Pollution Analyst, Conservation Officer.

Fascinated by Maps? GIS Specialist, Cartographer, Utilities Manager, Remote Sensing Analyst

Interested in human behaviour? Planner, Social Worker, Market Researcher, Housing Officer, Estate Agent.

Want to know why people work where they do? Economic Developer, Location Analyst, Retailor, Regional Developer, Transport Manager.

Interested in world events? Aid Worker, Diplomat, Refugee Advisor, Charity Co-ordinator.

Famous geographers – Matthew Pinsent and James Cracknell, Amy MacDonald, Anita Roddick, Iain Stewart, Mother Teresa, Prince William, Ben Fogle, Steve Irwin, Nicholas Hodgson, Michael Jordan, Rob Andrew, Kurt Angel, Gethin Jones, Theresa May

History

Studying History at exam level can lead to several different careers. Students who enjoy the study of the different periods of History often consider teaching, museum work or archaeology. However, most History students follow different paths, using the analytical and written skills they develop to follow careers in law, journalism, public relations and politics, among others.

Mathematics

Mathematics is a great basis for many jobs especially:

Actuary

Accountant
Analyst
Banker
Chemist
Computer programmer
Doctor
Engineer
Economist
Statistician
Teacher

Media Studies

An engaging and up-to-date qualification that seeks to train students in the skills needed to interpret and analysis media in its myriad forms. From looking more closely at the front cover of your favourite magazine, to considering marketing approaches through social media.

When you have acquired these new skills many career options will be open to you:

Marketing
PR
Journalism Film & TV
Advertisingto name but a few.

Music

Music works well alongside: English; History; Media: Graphics; Art; Physics and Maths, offering the potential to follow a variety of career paths:

Performing – soloists, orchestras, bands, session work.
Composing – multimedia; Film; TV
Music Administration – Concerts, Theatre Festivals & Events
Journalism
Law
Medicine - especially music therapy.
Teaching - class and instrumental
Architecture – awareness of acoustics and space

Languages

Pick a foreign language, any foreign language. No matter what language it is, the beauty of having a language is that there is no one given career path. Language skills are in demand and can open up opportunities in areas that you may never even have thought to look. Teaching, translating and interpreting are obvious career options, but languages can be used in almost any career, particularly within businesses that trade internationally. Marketing, the Diplomatic Service, Broadcasting, Civil Service, Editing and Publishing are also popular career paths.

Religious Education

The ability to understand other people's viewpoints and be a good listener are invaluable skills if you intend working with people.

Specific careers include:

United Nations, charity work, social work, law, police, teaching to name but a few careers.

Photography

Photography can be great preparation for any career that requires creative thinking, visual literacy, presentation skills, problem solving and an eye for aesthetic. More specific careers include:

Advertising photographer, fashion photographer, photojournalist, food photographer, portrait photographer, wedding photographer, documentary photographer, fine art photographer, wildlife photographer

Physical Education

GCSE is a fun, engaging and challenging GCSE that not only tests your sporting ability, but students' knowledge of World sport past and present, in addition to the anatomy and physiology topics which make up most of the syllabus. For this reason, student's career paths would include occupations where there is a mix between physical activity and science.

This would include Physiotherapy, sports coaching, sport analysts, statisticians, teaching or even working closely with elite sports men and women. Taking GCSE PE would naturally lead into taking A level PE followed up with a degree in sports science. As the sporting industry is ever changing and advancing year by year, who know what jobs will be around in 8 years' time. That is why Sport and PE is so exciting!

Science

Just a few of the jobs related to studying science:

Doctor
Veterinarian
Pharmacist
Dentist
Electrician
Engineer
Physiotherapist
Dietician
Audio/video technician
Pilot
Animal trainer
Sport scientist
Forensic scientist
And not forgetting Astronaut!